

22 Local Marketing

(Formerly VicTree Websites LLC)

FREE RESOURCE

THE TREE CARE CITATIONS LIST

Where your business needs to be listed, in priority order | 22 Local Marketing

A citation is any place online that lists your business name, address, and phone number. Google and AI search tools cross-check these listings to decide whether you are real, established, and local. A consistent citation footprint quietly lifts map rankings; an inconsistent one quietly caps them. This is the list we work from, in the order we build it.

The rule that matters more than the list: identical everywhere.

Same business name, same address format, same phone number, on every single listing. "Moberly's Tree Service" on one site and "Moberlys Tree Svc LLC" on another reads as two different businesses to a machine. Fix inconsistencies before building anything new.

TIER 1: THE CORE

Every local business needs these, no exceptions. All free unless noted. Do these first.

PLATFORM	COST	NOTES
Google Business Profile	Free	The one that drives the map. See our GBP Optimization Checklist.
Bing Places	Free	Powers Bing maps and feeds Microsoft Copilot answers. Can import from Google.
Apple Business Connect	Free	Powers Apple Maps and Siri. Most competitors never claim it.
Facebook Business Page	Free	Complete the About section fully; it doubles as a citation.
Yelp	Free	Claim and complete it. Never solicit reviews here; let them come naturally.

Better Business Bureau	Free listing	Accreditation is paid and optional; the free profile still counts.
Nextdoor	Free	Neighborhood word of mouth, and increasingly quoted by AI tools for "recommended near me."
Angi	Free listing	Listing is free; their lead-selling upsells are optional and usually skippable.
Yellow Pages (yp.com)	Free	Old but still crawled everywhere.
Foursquare	Free	Feeds location data to dozens of apps and AI systems.
MapQuest	Free	Quick win, sourced from other data but claimable.
Local Chamber of Commerce	Paid	The single most "local" link and listing money can honestly buy.

TIER 2: INDUSTRY DIRECTORIES

Directories for the trades, tree work, and outdoor services. Authority scores shift over time, so treat them as rough weight, not gospel. Free ones first, then decide which paid ones earn their fee in your market.

DIRECTORY	COST	NOTES
Houzz	Free listing	High authority home services platform; portfolio photos shine here.
Porch	Free / Paid	One of the strongest home services directories.
Thumbtack	Free listing	Pay only for leads if you choose; the profile itself is the citation.
HomeAdvisor	Paid	Strong authority. The listing matters even if you never buy their leads.
BuildZoom	Paid	Contractor-focused, solid authority.
Networx	Paid	Contractor directory with real weight.
Contractors.com	Paid	General contractor directory.
Yardbook	Free	Lawn and outdoor services platform.
ProMatcher	Free	Free listing with a lawn/tree category.
Landscape.com	Free	Outdoor services directory.
eHardhat	Free	Contractor directory, quick free win.
HomeBlue	Paid	Home services directory.
TCIA (tcia.org)	Membership	Tree Care Industry Association. Members get a directory listing customers actually check. Worth it for the credibility alone.
TreesAreGood (ISA)	Certification	The find-an-arborist directory. Only available with an ISA Certified Arborist on staff, which is its own trust weapon.

TIER 3: LOCAL AND EVERYWHERE ELSE

- **Local news and community sites.** Sponsorships, event coverage, and "best of" lists in your actual town outweigh any national directory.
- **Suppliers and partners.** Equipment dealers, nurseries, and landscapers you work with often have partner pages. Real relationships make the best citations.
- **City and county business registries.** Free, official, and trusted by machines.

HOW TO WORK THE LIST

- **Fix before you build.** Run a free listing scan, correct every mismatched name, address, and phone first.
- **One listing per site, ever.** Duplicates hurt more than missing listings. Claim and merge duplicates before adding anything.
- **Write a unique description for each.** Pasting the same paragraph 40 times looks automated. Vary it honestly.
- **Track it.** Keep a simple sheet: site, login, date, status. Future you will be grateful.
- **Never buy bulk citation blasts.** 500 spam directories for \$50 creates cleanup work, not rankings.

What this looks like in practice

Tier 1 in the first month, the free half of Tier 2 in the second, then a slow, tracked drip of the rest. Done once, kept consistent, it compounds quietly for years. This is included in every plan we run, but nothing on this list requires us.